A-A-53398
3 March 1988

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

FORCEPS, NASAL SEPTUM CUTTING, Cupped Blades
(Jansen-Middleton)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description.

This commercial item description covers a Jansen Middleton design, cupped blades, nasal septum cutting forceps suitable to grasp and cut the septum in nasal operative procedures.

Salient characteristics:

General. The forceps shall be nasal septum cutting forceps of the Jansen-Middleton design with an overall length of 7-1/2 inches. The forceps shall have cup-shaped, cross-action and double spring-separated handles.

Material. The forceps shall be fabricated from Class 4 martensitic corrosion-resistant steel in accordance with American Society for Testing and Materials (ASTM) Designation F899.

Hardness. The jaws of the forceps shall have a Rockwell Hardness C scale (HRC) 50 to 55. The remainder of the forceps shall have a Rockwell Hardness C scale (HRC) 40 to 47. The hardness shall be tested in accordance with ASTM Designation E18 or ASTM Designations E92 and E140.

Style, design and dimensions. The style, design and dimensions of the forceps shall be in accordance with Defense Personnel Support Center (DPSC) Drawing No. 24522. The handle of the forceps shall be serrated. As an alternate, the handle may have a fingerguard. The handle springs shall open the forceps smoothly from the closed position. All hinged joints shall operate without binding or excessive looseness.

Passivation. The forceps shall be properly passivated.

AMSC N/A FSC 6515
DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:19Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Finish. The finish shall be satin. The finish shall be uniform and free from burrs, pits, rough areas, scars and grind and tool marks.

Resistance to corrosion. The forceps shall show no sign of corrosion when tested in accordance with ASTM Designation F1089.

Identification marking. Forceps shall be permanently marked with the contractor's name registered trademark and the word "stainless". In addition, forceps of foreign manufacture shall bear the name of the country of manufacture.

Workmanship. The forceps shall be processed in such a manner as to be uniform and free from defects which affect life, utility, or appearance.

PRODUCT QUALITY LEVEL.

Visual and dimensional examination. Shall be examined to verify that design, construction and workmanship are in accordance with applicable requirements.

Materials. The supplier shall be responsible for performing tests to assure that materials are in accordance with requirements specified.

Unit. Each (EA). One forceps, as specified, constitutes one unit.

Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:19Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

Examination. The forceps shall be examined to determine compliance with all requirements contained in this specification.

Sampling for examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, with an AQL of 1.0 (percent defective) and an inspection level of II. The unit of product for examination purposes shall be one forceps.

Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

Sampling for tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD 105 and as specified herein. The unit of product for test purposes shall be one forceps. Sampling shall be level S-1, AQL 1.0.

Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producers' own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:19Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Public Law 94-580 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

NOTE: The following National Stock Number is covered by this document:

NSN	ITEM IDENTIFICATION
6515-00-336-2900	FORCEPS, NASAL SEPTUM CUTTING, Cupped Jaws, Jansen-Middleton, 7-1/2 Inch

Ordering data (Intermediate/exterior package quantities and labeling and marking must be specified in the contract and/or order).

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Preparing Activity:

DoD-MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:19Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

VA-OSS
PHS
FDA-MPQAS

PGC 45339

Project No. 6515-4117

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:19Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

INSTRUCTIONS In a continuing effort to make our standardization documents better, the DoD provides this form for use in submitting comments and suggestions for improvements. All users of military standardization documents are invited to provide suggestions. This form may be detached, folded along the lines indicated, taped along the loose edge *(DO NOT STAPLE)*, and mailed. In block 5, be as specific as possible about particular problem areas such as wording which required interpretation, was too rigid, restrictive, loose, ambiguous, or was incompatible, and give proposed wording changes which would alleviate the problems. Enter in block 6 any remarks not related to a specific paragraph of the document. If block 7 is filled out, an acknowledgement will be mailed to you within 30 days to let you know that your comments were received and are being considered.

NOTE This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, deviations, or clarification of specification requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements.

(Fold along this line)

(Fold along this line)

OFFICIAL BUSINESS
PENALTY FOR PRIVATE USE $300

BUSINESS REPLY MAIL
FIRST CLASS PERMIT NO. 4966 Alexandria, VA

POSTAGE WILL BE PAID BY

Commander
Defense Personnel Support Center
ATTN: DPSC-RSTS
2800 South 20th Street
Philadelphia, Pennsylvania 19101-8419

NO POSTAGE
NECESSARY
IF MAILED
IN THE
UNITED STATES

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:19Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1 DOCUMENT NUMBER	2 DOCUMENT TITLE
A-A-53398	FORCEPS , NASAL SEPTUM CUTTING, Cupped Blades (Jansen-Middleton)

3a NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4 TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
b ADDRESS *(Street City State ZIP Code)*	☐ USER
	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)* _____

5 PROBLEM AREAS

a Paragraph Number and Wording

b Recommended Wording

c Reason/Rationale for Recommendation

6 REMARKS

7a NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last First MI)* – Optional	b WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c MAILING ADDRESS *(Street City State ZIP Code)* – Optional	8 DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:19Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.